



OHA District 2

Three River Valleys News

May 2026 – Vol. 13, No. 1

1. DIRECTOR'S MESSAGE

Dear Society and Garden Club Members,

Thanks again to all of you who attended the D2 Annual Meeting on April 18th. Unfortunately, there are still several vacancies on the new board, the most critical one being the secretary position. We also need three new Assistant District Directors (ADDs) to take on those roles in their respective river basins.

With regard to the upcoming D2 Flower Show, the membership passed a motion allocating up to \$2700 toward expenses incurred for staging this year's show. A show of this size costs an average of \$4000 to produce but the benefits come back to members in prize money and promotion of our clubs. D2 has healthy assets to work with and, as a non-profit, we are in the business of giving back to the community. Take advantage of this great event by entering the show.

Elsewhere in this newsletter, you will find more information on the upcoming OHA Convention in Oshawa (Durham College).

Greg Laws, Director, District 2



Congratulations to Ursula Zeis,
Madawaska Valley Gardening Club, for winning *Best in Show*
For this entry in the 2026 Photography Competition.
Attendees at the D2 Annual Meeting on April 18th enjoyed a
PowerPoint presentation of the winning entries

CONTENTS

1. Director's Message
2. Upcoming Events Calendar

INFO FOR MEMBERS

3. Nepean Hosts a Great Day
4. Your New Board of Directors
5. Congratulations Service Award Winner!
6. See You at the 32nd Annual Flower & Edibles Show
7. Photo Competition 2027
8. Nominate a Conservation Champion
9. OHA Convention
10. You Have a Pollinator Garden!

INFO FOR PRESIDENTS

11. 2026 Youth Grants Still Available
12. Promoting Our Societies and Clubs

2. UPCOMING EVENTS CALENDAR

MAY	JUNE	JULY/AUGUST	SEPTEMBER	OCTOBER
<u>May 22:</u> Deadline to Enter 32nd Annual Flower Show	<u>June 1:</u> Deadline to apply for Youth Grant <u>June 13:</u> 32 nd Annual Flower & Edibles Show 	Enjoy the garden tours!	Check out the Fall Shows!	<u>Date TBD:</u> Fall Advisory hosted by the Madawaska Valley Gardening Club

3. NEPEAN HOSTS A GREAT DAY

Thank you to Jack Wilson and his team at Nepean Horticultural Society for hosting the Annual Meeting on April 18, 2026. Seventy-five members from 15 societies attended and enjoyed two informative speakers:

- Dr. Pete Dang has spearheaded the restoration of the Pinhey Sand Dunes and regaled us with information on the plethora of flora and fauna that have re-established at the Pinhey Sand Dunes off Slack Road (Ottawa).
- Dr. Jean Carr brought us news of his and Kathleen Fischer's project to raise native trees for distribution to the public with the objective of greatly improving the amount of tree canopy in Ottawa. Their cadre of volunteers collect and propagate native tree seeds. The nursery is on the Canadensis grounds on Prince of Wales Drive across from the Experimental Farm.



Nepean Horticultural Society hosts from left to right - Liz Livermore, Marian Barton, Elaine Petermann

Photo credit - G. MacQuarrie

4. YOUR NEW BOARD OF DIRECTORS

Greg Laws, Past President of the Greater Ottawa Water Garden Horticultural Society (GOWGHS), is now your District Director. He was unopposed in his bid for the position and we thank him for stepping forward to assume this role.

Many thanks Ruth Anderson who served as your very capable District Director in the last term. Unfortunately, due to health concerns, she was unable to continue on the Executive.

Also stepping down after many years of service is Anne Harbord. Anne has been a tireless promoter of our district for over two decades. A wealth knowledge on everything gardening, she will be sorely missed. We know, however, that she will not slow down but will turn her attention to other pursuits in her “retirement”. Thank you, Anne, for everything.

This is your 2026/27 Board of Directors as of the Annual Meeting held on April 18, 2026:

POSITION	NAME	YEARS Completed
District Director	Greg Laws	0
Asst District Director, Rideau River Basin	vacant	
Assistant District Director, Mississippi River Basin	Carol Alexander (Almonte)	0
Asst District Director, Upper Ottawa River Basin	vacant	
Asst District Director-at-Large	vacant	
Treasurer	Darlene Bourne (Pakenham)	2
Secretary	vacant	0
Financial Reviewer	Margret Koppert	n/a
Financial Reviewer	Sandy Jackson	n/a



Native tree saplings available from Ottawa South Eco-Action Network (OSEAN) **LIMITED QUANTITIES**. Minimum donation of \$5. Pick-up **May 15, 2026**. MORE INFORMATION at osean.info@gmail.com

Pictured: Pagoda Dogwood, a beautiful native shrub – one of the saplings that will be available from OSEAN.

5. CONGRATULATIONS SERVICE AWARD WINNER!



Congratulations to Carol Alexander of Almonte Horticultural Society for winning the 2026 District Service Award. Cindy Zorgel, Past District Director and member of the Almonte Horticultural Society, thanked Carol for her tireless contribution to the activities of the society.

District Director Greg Laws presents the District Service Award to Carol Alexander, Almonte Horticultural Association

Photo credit: G. MacQuarrie

6. SEE YOU AT THE 32nd ANNUAL FLOWER SHOW

[SHOW SCHEDULE](#)

JUNE 13, 2026

PRE-REGISTRATION YOUR DESIGN OR SPECIAL EXHIBIT BY MAY 22, 2026

Please contact Linda Bartlett, at Imbartlett62@gmail.com to registrar.

DESIGN CLASSES

Spaces Still Available

- Class 65 "Rise to the Occasion" – a tall design
- Class 66 "The Whistle" – a Miniature
- Class 67 "Offside" – a Decorative Parallel Design
- Class 68 "Penalty Kick" – a design showing motion
- Class 69 "Frenzied Fans" – a design of your choosing
- Class 70 "World Cup" – a design incorporating metal
- Class 71 "Team Jersey" – a design where red and white predominate

- Class 72 **"The Crowd Wave"** – a Pavé Design
- Class 73 **"The Goalie Box"** – a Modern Design
- Class 74a **"Referee"** – a Duo Design, side one *
- Class 74b **"Goalie"** – a Duo Design, side two *

*There are only six (6) entries in total for Class 74, however, each side of the design is treated as a separate class and ribbons, etc., are awarded accordingly. Each entry can be in one container or in two containers that appear as one unit.

SPECIAL EXHIBITS

A Special Award for the *Best in Show - Special Exhibit* is a gift certificate generously donated by Artistic Landscape Designs LTD (\$100 value). A Special Award for *Judge's Choice – Special Exhibit* is a gift certificate generously donated by Black Sheep Perennials (\$100 value).

- Class 75 **"Burnt Lands Alvar"** – A Dish Garden
- Class 76 **"Tulip Festival"** – A Spring Planter
- Class 77 **"A Soccer Game"** – A Fairy Garden
- Class 78 **"Experimental Farm Greenhouses"** – A Terrarium

The Richcraft Recreation Complex in Kanata is a fabulous facility and we are grateful to Ottawa City Councillor Cathy Curry for donating the space. As well, a huge thank you goes to one of our own – a horticultural society member in District 2 who has donated \$2000 to make the show a success but who wishes to remain anonymous.

After you've placed your exhibits
Enjoy a floral design demonstration by
Accomplished Designer, Judy Fine
2 to 3 pm



Tell your family and friends – there are Open Classes for adults and youth to enter. Kids can make a bug hotel or fairy garden to take home (1 to 4 pm).

In keeping with the show theme – World Cup Comes to Canada! -- enter a free draw for a chance to win a package of four game tickets to a Atlético Ottawa 2026 season game.

**IT TAKES US ALL TO MAKE THIS THE
LARGEST FLOWER SHOW IN EASTERN ONTARIO!**

7. PHOTO COMPETITION 2027

We are thrilled to have Kathleen Teahen as coordinator for the 2027 Photo Competition. Kathleen is a long-time member of the West Carleton Gardening Club and Horticultural Society. She has an interest in photography and is an avid photographer.

The photos will feature Ontario's seasons by the activity reflected in the image of a garden which draws the viewer in and reflects the photographer's inspiration for taking the image.

The photos are to be in colour and may be taken with the lens that the photographer chooses to best capture the image. Judging Scale: Interpretation 40%, Composition 40%, Appearance & Impact 20%.

THEME: Visitors to the Garden Through Ontario's Seasons

- Class 1: "The First Breath of Spring"
- Class 2: "Sizzling Summer's Shelters"
- Class 3: "A Blaze of Autumn Glory"
- Class 4: "Sparkling Winter Wonderland"
- Class 5: "A Favourite Close-up"
- Class 6: "Good Enough to Eat"

Pictures should have been taken in the 24 months prior to March 15, 2027. All images may be used for any purpose that District 2 designates, the exhibitor (photographer) retains ownership rights of the photograph. While the winning photographs will be published in the District 2 newsletter and on social media, there will be no compensation payable to the photographer for the use of their photo.

The rules of the competition will be posted in the near future in the District 2 web page, on the Ontario Horticultural Association web site. Also posted will be a Release Form which must be completed by individuals who are photographed and the photo is subsequently entered in the competition.

8. NOMINATE A CONSERVATION CHAMPION

Do you know a conservation champion whose efforts and accomplishments deserve recognition? Now is your chance to nominate them for one of Ontario Nature's Conservation Awards. Deadline for nominations is June 30, 2026.

[Make a Nomination](#)

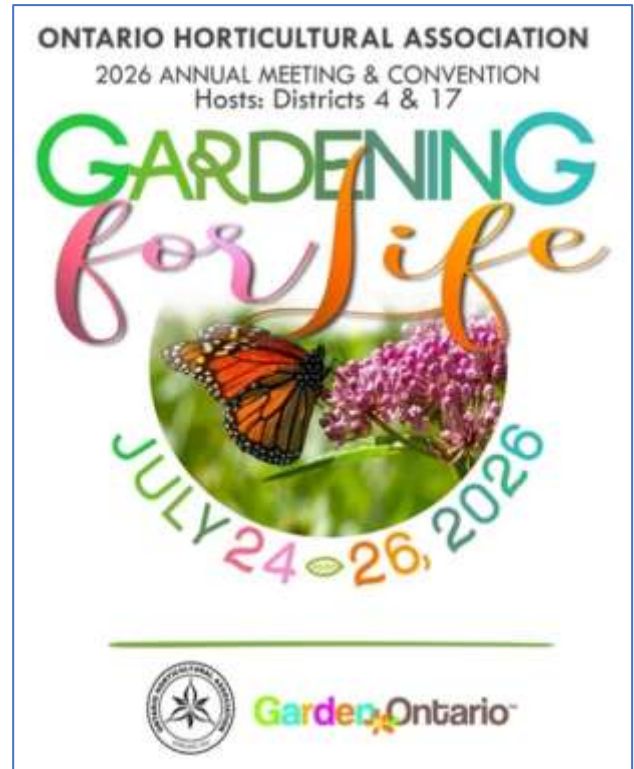


9. OHA CONVENTION

Information of the Ontario Horticultural Association is now available:

[OHA CONVENTION INFO](#)

June 1, 2026 is the deadline to enter the Flower Show and Arts Competition.



10. YOU HAVE A POLLINATOR GARDEN!

Let the world know that you are a friend of the pollinator birds and bees by including a garden sign from the Ontario Horticultural Association. Available for \$35 (in English or French) at

[OHA GARDEN SHOP](#)

11. 2026 YOUTH GRANTS STILL AVAILABLE

There are still some youth grants available for this year. To get the \$100 grant apply before June 1, 2026.

[YOUTH GRANT APPLICATION FOR 2026](#)

12. PROMOTING OUR SOCIETIES AND CLUBS

In addition to having a District 2 Facebook page and a Web page on the Ontario Horticultural Association site on the Internet. We now can be found on Instagram under [ottawa valley gardeners 5A 5b](#). If you have something you would like to promote on social media, contact Lori at loriray@storm.ca (Facebook) or Gay at gardens.gay@outlook.com (Instagram).

You can also use the District 2 QR code on all your promotional material. This helps promote our clubs as well.

Finally, be sure to forward this newsletter to your members.



WAFA RULES FOR DESIGN

1. An exhibit is made of plant materials, with or without accessories, within the space specified in the show Schedule.
2. Plant material must predominate over all other components of the exhibit.
3. The use of artificial plant material is forbidden unless stated in the regulations.
4. Fresh plant material must be in water or water-retaining material unless such material remains turgid throughout the event i.e. some tropicals.

All entries must be pre-registered by Tuesday, June 23, 2026.

Early registration would be appreciated by contacting the convener for each class.

In the event that you cannot meet your commitment, you must provide a replacement exhibitor and notify your convener prior to the show.

For full details on staging, questions may be directed to either of the Design Co-Chairs listed below.

Design Co -chairs
ANNE HARBORD
anneclark.flowers@gmail.com
513 850 8022

MARY-ANN VERCAMMEN
ma.vercammen@hotmail.com
416 918 1418

Registrar
ELIZABETH SCHLICHER
roseanne@sympatico.ca
905 335 9399

AWARDS : Sunday, July 12th, 3:30 pm

DESIGN DIVISION - RULES AND REGULATIONS

1. Classes are open to all interested exhibitors. Membership not required to enter. No Professional Florists. One entry per exhibitor per design class.
2. Design entries can be placed on:
Friday, July 10th between 5:00 pm - 10:00 pm
Saturday, July 11th between 8:00 am - 9:30 am
3. All designers must leave the show areas by Saturday, July 11th at 9:30 am. Judging at 10:00 am. Designs may be removed Sunday, July 12th between 4:30 pm - 5:00 pm.
4. No one may move a design except the exhibitor.
5. All plant material must be kept in good condition for the duration of the show. The Show Committee reserves the right to change or remove wilting plant material.
6. All entries must be the work of the exhibitor.
7. Designs can be pre-made as work space is limited.
8. Position in a class will be first come first choice.
9. At least 1 fresh Lily (genus Liliun) or Lily parts must be included in each design.
10. The Show Committee will take reasonable precautions to ensure the safety of the exhibits. The Society will not be held responsible for loss through or theft or breakage.



Fifty-Ninth Anniversary

ANNUAL LILY SHOW

Ontario Regional Lily Society
Royal Botanical Gardens
Atrium

LILIES AT THE JUNOS

Bringing the *collective soul* of the **FLORAL** and **MUSICAL ARTS** within one *Sacred Space*

**Saturday and Sunday
July 11 & 12, 2026**

10:00 am to 5:00 pm

SOIL FOR THE SOUL – J. Grasmuk

You are receiving this newsletter as a member of a garden club/horticultural society of District 2 of the Ontario Horticultural Association. Comments, inquiries -- please email District2News@gmail.com.